Tim Everard

Esports Operations and Delivery Lead

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PROFILE

Esports and live events operations leader with 15 years' experience, from theatre lighting and TV studio builds to heading Esports Operations at BLAST. Led a six-person department delivering tournament and player operations across every BLAST title, including CS2, Dota 2, Rocket League and Fortnite, working with the product and commercial teams to cost, pitch and deliver new tournament work. Across six years at BLAST that meant 60+ flagship events and 300+ qualifiers in 13 countries, 2,000+ freelancers and €12m+ in budgets. I build the clear processes, documentation and tools that keep many teams and partners working from the same information, and I know the esports and gaming world from the inside.

60+	300+	13	2,000+	€12m+
flagship esports events	qualifiers	countries	freelancers	in budgets

EXPERIENCE

Head of Esports Operations — Jun 2023 – Oct 2026
BLAST

- Led a six-person department running tournament operations across every BLAST ecosystem, including CS2, Dota 2, Brawl Stars, Fortnite, Rocket League and Rainbow Six
- Costed and pitched new tournament work with the product and commercial teams
- Set technical requirements for commercial partnerships
- Brought Team Operations into the department, so all online and offline player management and support sat with one team
- Rebuilt how the department works, with clearer ownership, accountability and proper documentation
- Designed and built the department's own tools for tournament operations, event and equipment tracking, freelancer calendars, bookings and contracting, and event budgets and deadlines
- Wrote the business case for a departmental OPEX budget covering equipment renewal, software and cross-event costs

KEY SKILLS

Cross-team coordination
Stakeholder management, product and commercial teams, partnerships, pitch costings

Operations leadership
Team leadership, people management, restructuring, process improvement

Event management
Tournament and player operations, event logistics, site visits, bootcamps

Commercial and finance
Budgets, business cases, invoices, pitch costings

Systems and tooling
Airtable, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office

Freelancers and vendors
Freelancer booking, contracting and payments, rotas, vendor management

Broadcast and technical
Studio builds, Blackmagic, vMix, Ross Video, lighting, audio

CERTIFICATIONS

First Aid at Work	2022
Safeguarding Lead (DSL)	2021
Working at Heights	2018
Moving Head Maintenance	2018
Manual Handling	2018
Fire Marshal	2018
PAT Testing	2016
IPAF	2012

References available on request.

Tournament Operations Manager

Jan 2020 – Jun 2023

BLAST · Contractor to Mar 2021, then permanent

- Main tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams
- Managed tournament equipment and staffing budgets across CS:GO, Dota 2, Apex Legends, FIFA, Fortnite and Rainbow Six
- Booked and managed tournament operations freelancers for internal, external and online productions
- Approved equipment and staffing invoices, and decided when to hire, buy or repair tournament kit
- Arranged venues and equipment for team bootcamps
- Designated Safeguarding Lead and first aider at live events

Broadcast Freelancer

Jan 2018 – Jan 2020

Self-employed · Alongside Jam Television

- Crewed broadcasts and live events for clients including BLAST Pro Series, ESL UK and ESL Germany, BBC, Sky Sports, ITV, Immediate Media, NATS, Big Ben (WRC), Altitude Angels and Create Broadcasting
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live shows
- On-stage admin at esports events, and consulted on production and technical setups for clients

Broadcast and Studio Manager

Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

Jam Television · Birmingham

- Designed a multi-camera TV studio from scratch, bought the equipment, and managed installation and testing
- Controlled the studio budget, including equipment purchasing
- Hired freelancers and ran staff rotas to keep a 24-hour TV channel on air, including holiday cover and emergency call-outs
- Managed suppliers, invoice approval and day-to-day maintenance, including software and hardware updates
- Trained staff on studio equipment and workflows

Production Manager

Jul 2015 – Dec 2017

ESL UK · Leicester

- Managed production for both ESL UK studios and at external events including MCM, EGX and Formula E
- Built and set up the technical infrastructure for two ESL UK studios
- Controlled production budgets and purchased studio and event equipment
- Hired freelance crew, managed rotas and supervised internal and external staff on live shows
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live broadcasts
- Trained crew on equipment and workflows, and ran equipment hire, installation, testing and maintenance

Senior Lighting and Event Technician

Jun 2012 – Jun 2015

Dorking Halls · Casual Technician Mar 2010 – Jan 2011

- Controlled the equipment and training budget, and ran in-house lighting training
- Set up and ran touring and in-house performances
- Maintained specialist kit for a theatre and two cinemas, from lighting and audio desks to 35mm and digital projectors
- Covered whatever the show needed, working as audio engineer, stage hand or stage manager
- Head of lighting for The Darkness's support act, support lighting engineer for Enter Shikari, head of audio and lighting for Lee Mack, and comedy tours with Jimmy Carr, Dara Ó Briain and Ed Byrne